

GREAT SKY AI

Website Handoff Guide

Everything you need to take ownership of the Great Sky AI website, deploy it under your own accounts, and connect your domain.

PREPARED BY

Lightsmith Design

VERSION

1.0

LIVE PREVIEW

great-sky-ai.vercel.app

SECTION 01

What you are receiving

The Great Sky AI website is a **static site** — plain HTML, CSS and JavaScript. There is no database, no server-side code, no build step and no monthly software cost. This makes it fast, extremely cheap to host (free on Vercel's Hobby tier for most usage), and simple to maintain.

Item	Details
Live preview URL	great-sky-ai.vercel.app
Source code	GitHub repository: LightsmithDesign/Great-Sky
Technology	Static HTML5, CSS3, vanilla JavaScript. No frameworks, no build step.
Hosting	Vercel (currently under the developer's account — to be transferred)
Pages	Home, Tech, About, Careers, News, Contact, Privacy, Terms, plus 6 news articles and 4 job listings
Fonts	STIX Two Text, Inter, Atkinson Hyperlegible Mono (loaded free via Google Fonts)

Read this first

There are **two items that must be completed before the site is publicly launched** (Section 02). The site is fully built and designed, but the contact form is not yet connected to an inbox, and search engines are currently blocked from indexing the site. Both are intentional pre-launch states and are quick to resolve.

SECTION 02

Critical items before going live

These two items are the only things standing between the current build and a fully live, public website. Neither is a defect — both are deliberate pre-launch safeguards that must be switched off at launch.

1. The contact and newsletter forms do not yet deliver messages

Right now, when a visitor submits the contact form or subscribes to the newsletter, they see a success message — but **the submission is not sent anywhere and is not stored**. The forms are built and styled, but not yet wired to a backend service.

To fix, pick one of these options (all have generous free tiers):

Option	Best for	Effort
Formspree	Fastest setup. Point the form at a URL, messages arrive by email.	~15 min
Vercel Forms / Functions	Staying entirely inside Vercel.	~1 hour
Supabase	Storing submissions in a database you own and query later.	~2 hours

The relevant code is in `script.js`, in the `contact-form` and `subscribe-form` handlers. Each is marked with a comment explaining where to connect the backend.

2. Search engines are currently blocked

The site sends a `noindex` instruction on every page, which tells Google and other search engines not to list the site. This is correct while the site lives on a temporary preview URL — it prevents the preview from competing with the real domain in search results.

To fix at launch: open `vercel.json` and delete the `X-Robots-Tag` header block shown below, then redeploy.

```
{
  "source": "/*(.*)",
  "headers": [
    { "key": "X-Robots-Tag", "value": "noindex" } <-- DELETE THIS BLOCK
  ]
}
```

Timing matters

Do not remove the noindex until **after** your real domain is connected and working. Removing it early lets Google index the temporary *.vercel.app* address, which can then compete with your real domain in search results.

SECTION 03

Steps for the developer

These are handled by Lightsmith Design before or during handoff. Listed here so both sides know what has been done.

A. Strip private credentials before sending the code

If sending the code as a ZIP rather than via GitHub transfer, **these must be deleted from the folder first** — they contain the developer's own Vercel account credentials:

```
great-sky-site/.env.local <- contains a Vercel access token  
great-sky-site/.vercel/ <- links the folder to the developer's Vercel project
```

Both are already excluded from the GitHub repository, so a GitHub transfer is clean by default. This only applies to sending a ZIP.

B. Hand over the repository

Choose one:

- **Transfer the repo** (recommended) — GitHub: Settings, Danger Zone, Transfer ownership. The client keeps the full commit history and the repo leaves the developer's account.
- **Client forks or re-uploads** — the developer keeps a copy; the client starts a fresh repository from the delivered files.

C. Decide what happens to the current Vercel project

The site is currently deployed under the developer's personal Vercel account. Once the client has their own deployment working, the developer should delete the old project so there is only one live copy and no duplicate URL floating around.

D. Confirm the client receives

- The GitHub repository (transferred or fresh)
- This handoff guide
- The brand style guide and value icon SVG exports
- Confirmation of which items in Section 02 remain outstanding

SECTION 04

Getting the site running under your accounts

Follow these in order. No coding experience is required for any step. Budget roughly 30–45 minutes, plus DNS propagation time.

Step 1 — Create a GitHub account

GitHub stores the website's code and its history. Go to **github.com** and sign up. A free account is sufficient. Use a company email address rather than a personal one, so the account can outlive any single employee.

Step 2 — Take ownership of the code

If the developer is transferring the repository, you will receive an email invitation from GitHub — accept it, and the repository appears in your account. Nothing further is needed.

If instead you received a ZIP of the files:

- 1 In GitHub, click **New repository**. Name it (for example, *great-sky-website*).
- 2 Set it to **Private** unless you want the code publicly visible.
- 3 Do not add a README, .gitignore, or license — leave those unchecked.
- 4 Click **Create repository**, then use **uploading an existing file** and drag in the contents of the `great-sky-site` folder.

Step 3 — Create a Vercel account

Vercel is the hosting platform. Go to **vercel.com** and choose **Continue with GitHub** — signing in this way automatically links the two accounts, which makes the next step trivial. The Hobby (free) plan is genuinely sufficient for a marketing site of this size.

A note on plans

Vercel's free Hobby plan prohibits commercial use in its terms. For a company website, the **Pro plan (currently around \$20/month per member)** is the compliant choice. The site itself is small enough that you will not approach any usage limits.

Step 4 — Deploy the site

- 1 In the Vercel dashboard click **Add New, Project**.
- 2 Find your repository in the list and click **Import**.
- 3 Leave every build setting at its default. This is a static site — there is no build command and no framework to select. If Vercel asks for a Framework Preset, choose **Other**.
- 4 If your repository contains the `great-sky-site` folder at its root rather than the files directly, set **Root Directory** to `great-sky-site`.
- 5 Click **Deploy** and wait about a minute.

You will be given a temporary address ending in `.vercel.app`. Open it and confirm the site loads correctly before continuing.

SECTION 05

Connecting your domain

This points your real web address (for example *greatsky.ai*) at the site you just deployed. You will need access to wherever the domain was purchased — the **registrar** (GoDaddy, Namecheap, Cloudflare, Google Domains and so on).

Step 1 — Add the domain in Vercel

- 1 Open your project in Vercel, then **Settings, Domains**.
- 2 Type your domain (for example *greatsky.ai*) and click **Add**.
- 3 Vercel will display the exact DNS records you need to create. **Use the values Vercel shows you** — they are specific to your project and occasionally change.

Step 2 — Add those records at your registrar

Log in to your registrar, find the DNS settings for the domain, and add the records Vercel gave you. They will look something like this:

Type	Name / Host	Value
A	@	(the IP address Vercel displays)
CNAME	www	cname.vercel-dns.com

The @ symbol means the domain itself (*greatsky.ai*); *www* covers *www.greatsky.ai*. Adding both means the site works either way.

Step 3 — Wait, then verify

DNS changes typically take 10 to 60 minutes to take effect, but can occasionally take up to 48 hours. Vercel's Domains screen shows a live status and will display a valid checkmark once everything resolves. HTTPS (the padlock) is issued automatically and free — you do not need to buy an SSL certificate.

Do not delete the old deployment yet

Keep the developer's original deployment online until your own domain is confirmed working. Once it is, ask the developer to remove theirs so only one live copy exists.

Step 4 — Turn on search engine indexing

Now that the real domain works, complete item 2 from Section 02: remove the X-Robots-Tag block from `vercel.json` and redeploy. Then submit the domain to **Google Search Console** so Google begins indexing it.

SECTION 06

Editing the site going forward

Because the site is plain HTML, edits can be made directly in GitHub's web editor without installing anything. **Every time you save a change to the main branch, Vercel automatically redeploys the site within about a minute.**

Where things live

File or folder	What it controls
index.html	Home page
tech.html, about.html, careers.html, news.html, contact.html	The main interior pages
privacy.html, terms.html	Legal pages
news/	Individual news articles, one HTML file each
careers/	Individual job listings, one HTML file each
styles.css	All visual styling, colors and typography
script.js	Interactions: menu, scroll effects, form handling
assets/	All images, logos and photography
vercel.json	Hosting configuration (clean URLs, caching, the noindex setting)

Making a simple text edit

- 1 In GitHub, open the file you want to change.
- 2 Click the pencil icon (Edit this file).
- 3 Find the text and change it. Leave anything inside angle brackets alone.
- 4 Scroll down, click **Commit changes**.
- 5 Wait about a minute, then refresh the live site.

If something breaks

Every change is versioned. In GitHub, open the **Commits** history, find the last good version, and revert to it — the site will roll back automatically. Nothing is ever permanently lost.

Adding a news article or job listing

Duplicate an existing file in news/ or careers/, rename it, edit its contents, then add a link to it on the corresponding index page (news.html or careers.html). Matching the structure of the existing files keeps the styling consistent automatically.

SECTION 07

Security and code audit

A full review of the codebase was completed at handoff. Results below.

Passed

Check	Result
Secrets in source code	None found. No API keys, passwords or tokens are committed.
Credential files	Correctly excluded from version control.
External link safety	All 88 external links use rel=noopener, preventing tab-hijacking.
Broken links	None. All internal links and asset references resolve.
Image accessibility	All 92 images have descriptive alt text.
Form spam protection	Honeypot field present on the contact form.
JavaScript quality	Strict mode, no eval, no unsafe HTML injection, respects reduced-motion.
Leftover placeholders	None. No TODO, lorem ipsum or template text remains.
HTTPS	Enforced automatically, including HSTS.

Recommended improvements

None of these are urgent or block launch, listed in priority order.

Priority	Item	Detail
High	Image file sizes	The site totals about 19 MB. One background image is 4.2 MB (a PNG used for a photo). Converting the large PNGs to WebP or AVIF would cut load time substantially, especially on mobile.
Medium	Security headers	Add Content-Security-Policy, X-Frame-Options, X-Content-Type-Options and Referrer-Policy in vercel.json. Standard hardening for any public site.
Medium	Social preview images	Only the home page has an og:image. Other pages shared on social media will show no preview image. Add the same tag to the remaining 7 pages.

Priority	Item	Detail
Low	Lazy loading	20 of 92 images use lazy loading. Extending this to below-the-fold images would improve initial page speed.
Low	Canonical tags	No canonical URLs are set. Adding them helps search engines avoid duplicate-content confusion.

SECTION 08

Launch checklist

Work top to bottom. The site is fully live once every box is ticked.

Task	Owner
☐ Create GitHub account	Client
☐ Transfer or upload the repository	Both
☐ Create Vercel account (Pro plan for commercial use)	Client
☐ Import the repository and deploy	Client
☐ Confirm the temporary .vercel.app URL loads correctly	Client
☐ Add the domain in Vercel and copy the DNS records	Client
☐ Add the DNS records at the registrar	Client
☐ Wait for DNS to resolve and confirm HTTPS padlock	Client
☐ Connect the contact form to a backend service	Client
☐ Test the contact form end to end — send a real message	Client
☐ Remove the noindex header and redeploy	Client
☐ Submit the domain to Google Search Console	Client
☐ Delete the developer's original Vercel deployment	Developer
☐ Compress the oversized background images	Optional
☐ Add security headers	Optional

Questions

For anything unclear in this document, or for help with the contact form backend and image optimization, contact Lightsmith Design.